Army of Roaches

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Army of Roaches

by Xenakis (IceRosesCrown)

Summary

After being startled first thing in the morning, Bow and Glimmer find themselves fighting a cockroach in order to recover their room…

Notes

Well, this is gonna sounds super weird but, fr, this happened to me. Like, all you're gonna read. The tweets I put as inspiration for this prove it. Oh, and I think I didn't tweet the little issue with which this ends, but that part also happened…

Anyways, I hope you enjoy and have some fun reading these shenanigans. I wrote five fics using this event, for different fandoms, that is, and this is one with quite a soft couple, I believe.

I'll leave links to the other fics in the ending note. (Especially since this fic makes reference to the Catradora version I wrote)
Now please enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

- Inspired by My tweet that inspired this by Diaspro (Xenakis)
- Inspired by Second tweet that inspired this by Diaspro (Xenakis)
- Inspired by Third tweet that inspired this by Diaspro (Xenakis)

A new day began for Bright Moon and, with sunrise, Bow woke up, comfortably holding Glimmer between his arms. He wanted nothing but to remain like that, yet something was tickling his leg, and it became difficult to ignore.

He was still too sleepy to even think about it and simply raised his head to take a look at his leg.

—Gah! Glimmer!

He immediately jumped at the sight of a hideous roach that was standing on his leg, shaking Glimmer as his arms untangled from her. The next moment, he was off the bed and rushing to get his bow and arrows, and by the time Glimmer opened her eyes, all she could see was Bow aiming an arrow towards the bed.

—What the…

—Get off the bed, Glim! Quick!

But the Queen only brushed her eyes and asked —What are you talking about?

Further pulling back the arrow, he explained —We have a roach!

Immediately, Glimmer teleported next to Bow and readied her sparkles.

—Where is it!?

—I don't know. It was on my leg— he replied, with a lower tone, carefully walking to the side, still looking for it. —I don't see it now.

Glimmer suddenly saw something move quickly over the bed and tried to blast it but failed.

—Ugh! No! The bed!— she realized. —Damn it! I'll just go get some poison for it.

She immediately teleported away, leaving Bow alone with the cockroach. However, he was too focused on the bug and didn't notice. His aim was on the bed and an arrow loaded with a sticky goo flew as soon as he saw movement.

But he couldn't catch the roach.

—I have it!— Glimmer exclaimed, appearing in the room.

—Give it to me, please— Bow told her. —And leave the room.

Once she was out, he stood at the door, used some goo arrows to seal the windows, then threw the vial of poison, and struck it with a smoke arrow to scatter it through the whole room. Right after, he closed the door and rested his back against it.

—Ugh! I can't believe we have a roach problem!— Glimmer exclaimed, pacing in front of him. —What are we gonna do!? And why is it happening!?

—Um… the summer?— Bow suggested.

—Maybe? But it never happened before!

—Why don't we do this with every room? Just in case?

—I don't want to do this to everyone— Glimmer groaned, covering her face with both hands. —It takes hours for the rooms to be ready, and then everything has to be cleaned, and then…

—Sooner or later, there's a chance every room will need this, you know?— he insisted. However, with how distressed she was, he couldn't help but add —Why don't we take a page from Catra and Adora's book and go sleep outside tonight?

—We already had to explain ourselves last time, and it was *really* awkward, you know?

—Anywhere else you suggest?

—If possible, I wanna come back to our room!— she exclaimed.

—Alright, alright. And we will— he accepted. —But when that *thing* is dead.

That day, the Queen pretended nothing had happened and told no one about the roach that appeared. She had no idea how to deal with the issue if it was really affecting the whole palace, and preferred not to spread rumors about it. Everyone would freak out and start seeing cockroaches everywhere, she reckoned.

However, during dinner with Adora and Catra, Bow brought it up.

—…And it was *on my leg*— he told them, shivering in disgust. —Glim didn't tell you?

—I-I was busy all day— the Queen argued, looking away.

—They are just *so* gross— Catra commented. —You have to do something about them, Sparkles.

—I know! But… what!? We can't make everyone leave and throw poison in *every* room!

—What if there are more!? Like, what was it last time? "The family of the roach is planning revenge"?— Catra remembered. —We weren't far off…

—But we threw that poison in all the room!

—I don't know, Glim… If there are more…

—There won't be, Bow— she assured him.

—You know I can't even see them…— he insisted.

—But you kept your cool this morning— she pointed out.

—I guess— he admitted, looking away with a faint blush.

—Why are you so afraid of them?— Adora asked, before filling her mouth with food.

—They are so gross!— Catra quickly replied.

—Yeah… And, when I was little, I… fell on a whole and…— Bow began telling, but interrupted himself as he shivered. —There were so, *so* many roaches!

—His dads took forever to find him— Glimmer continued. —He told me about it a lot of times… Oh, and your brothers!

—They played pranks on me and crafted little wooden roaches— Bow recalled. —They would leave them in my room, or the table… Ugh— he groaned. —Until my dads grounded them all— he concluded, laughing slightly.

—Wow— Adora uttered.

—Normal siblings things…

The four of them laughed wholeheartedly at that and finished their dinner soon enough. It was time for them to return to their rooms; Glimmer and Bow knew what awaited them.

—Please, please, let the roach be in the middle of the room— the Queen muttered as they arrived.

Warily, they opened the door and a pestilent odor received them.

—There's *no way* we're sleeping here tonight…

—I know— Glimmer agreed. —But let me get rid of the roach now.

—Wait, wait— Bow stopped her, catching her arm. —Let's just… open the windows and let the room ventilate— he suggested. —You can get it tomorrow when this smell is gone.

—Ugh, fine… I don't really wanna breathe that air— she admitted. —But how do we take off the goo from the windows?

—Can you blast them from here?

—I think, yes— she nodded.

The Queen took aim and fired at the windows, perfectly hitting the green goo that promptly burnt and fell.

—We can clean this all tomorrow— Bow insisted. —I'll do it after you remove the roach. It better be dead.

—It is, I’m sure— Glimmer said, patting him on the back. —But now we have to find a place to sleep…

—If… we can’t sleep in the garden… Why don’t we go to Mystacor’s beach instead?

—Oh, Bow! That’s a great idea!— she exclaimed, excited. —No one would show up there early in the morning.

—It was that or sleeping in the Whispering Woods like we used to, but it’s too cloudy to see the stars from down here— Bow explained, blushing as he made it obvious he wanted a romantic place for them.

—Aww, Bow— Glimmer let out, realizing. She held onto his arm and smiled as she said — Then let’s go!

Immediately, she teleported them to the calm beach up on the floating island, but realized she forgot to take blankets. Bow wanted to tell her it was fine, yet before he could speak, Glimmer was gone. A moment after, she appeared with a pair of blankets for them to extend on the ground, although coughing from the terrible smell in their room.

For some hours, the two of them admired the starry sky and reminisced on the times during the war, when they would sleep outdoors if their trips were too long, except when they pulled all-nighters. Such fond memories made them better appreciate the current peace, and they both fell asleep with a smile, lulled by the murmur of the cloud-waves.

The next morning, as agreed, Glimmer found the bug and once again used a spell to obliterate it, which allowed Bow to safely handle the clean-up of the room. He got rid of the remaining goo around the windows, fixed the bed that had been burnt by Glimmer’s blast, and by nightfall it was ready for them to sleep on it again.

Finally, a good night sleep in the comfort of their bed again.

The next day, feeling a bit nostalgic, Bow invited Glimmer to have lunch at his dads' house, and they spent all afternoon talking, exchanging stories from their childhood, until the issue with the roach was risen.

—Oh, my poor Bow— Lance said. —Those bugs still haunt you!

—We’re still sorry we couldn’t find you earlier— George said. —Or that we took so long to stop your brothers’ pranks.

—It’s alright, dads— Bow quickly replied. —Even if that hadn’t happened, I’d still hate them. They are… ugh.

They couldn’t hold back a laugh at seeing Bow shiver, and he soon joined them. It was, actually, a bit funny, he had to admit.

—So now it’s solved?— Lance asked.

—Perhaps— Glimmer said. —Last time, more appeared in Adora and Catra's room…

—Do you have anywhere else to sleep if that happens?— George asked. —You can always stay here if you need.

—Oh, no need— Bow assured them. —It's alright. We have more rooms.

—Yeah! No need to worry.

—Then we wish you both a safe trip back— Lance told them, as they all got up to say their goodbyes.

That night, the Best Friends Squad had a hearty meal and discussed what they would do the next day, planning more reconstructions and relief efforts for the remaining towns. Afterwards, they thought, it would be good to somehow celebrate the repairs in Etheria were done. So they spent a few hours discussing ideas for a big party in a few months' time.

By the time they finally retired to bed, they were so exhausted they dropped onto the bed and almost immediately fell asleep.

However, Bow's sleep was too light as he was slightly paranoid. He didn't want to tell Glimmer, but he was so scared more roaches would appear, that he didn't want to stay in the room. Yet he preferred not to argue and went to sleep with her as he noticed how drained she was.

It hadn't been an hour yet when he regretted that decision.

A scratching sound woke him up and all his drowsiness disappeared. There weren't many explanations for the sound, which he soon heard again, and he tensed up with fear.

—I'm so sorry— he muttered, before shaking Glimmer slightly by the arm. —Love, wake up — he called.

—What?— the Queen groaned, confused.

—Hear that?

—Hear… what?— she asked, interrupted by a yawn.

They spent a moment in absolute silence, long enough that Bow thought he was imagining things, until the scratching noise sounded again.

—See!?

—You think that's…

—It has to be more roaches!— he exclaimed, albeit in a low tone. —Please, please. Let's leave!

Glimmer yawned again and groaned tiredly but replied —Alright…

Both got up and grabbed their clothes for the next morning, discussing in hushed tones what to do.

—I'll get some more poison and put it up there. It's coming from the upper wardrobes— the Queen decided. —You…

—I'll take the clothes with me. Where do we go?

—Well, we told your dads we didn't need a room, so…

—To the beach again?

—No, no— Glimmer shook her head. —Tonight's too cold.

—Erm… Sleepover with the girls?— Bow proposed. —I'll see if they are still awake.

—Alright— she sighed.

—Then let's go. I don't wanna stay here— he admitted.

—And tomorrow, we'll get the room fully cleaned. Like, all of it— Glimmer sentenced.

The Queen didn't spare a second and got a new bottle of poison, carefully placed it inside the wardrobes, and left the room immediately. She was just *so* tired, she would have fallen asleep right there in the corridor.

But before she could even sit against a wall, Bow showed up, hand extended for her to take. He led her to Adora and Catra's new room, the spare room, and told her they hadn't even gone to sleep yet, so they were thrilled to have a sleepover.

—You guys helped up with the roaches in our room, of course we'd return the favor— Adora assured them.

—Yeah— Catra agreed. —But Sparkles looks a bit sleepy— she pointed out, giggling. —I don't think we can do much before she's completely knocked out.

—I'll sleep, you guys have fun— Glimmer said, yawning again. —I see you all are very… awake.

Said and done, the Queen flopped down on the bed and promptly fell asleep, oblivious to how the other three were holding back their laughter.

—Are we sure she will be fine?— Adora then asked. —First our room, then yours…

—And let's not forget the ceiling…—Catra added.

—Yeah! That too!

—I suppose she'll be a bit stressed this week— Bow admitted. —But we can help her deal with this!

—You know we're up for that, Arrow Boy.

—Yeah, if we can rebuild entire towns, fixing the room and getting rid of those bugs will be easy— Adora agreed.

—We could surely do it faster than the staff— Bow laughed. —Your room is still being repaired.

—I *told you* to let us handle it— Catra reminded him.

—Glimmer doesn't want to burden us with this too— he explained.

—Yeah, but now we *have* to help— Adora insisted. —We could work by zones, grab a bunch of rooms, fully clean them, and when we're done, choose another couple of rooms to deal with.

—It's the only way to make sure there are no more cockroaches…

—I know— Bow nodded. —It's likely just the heat of the summer, but that means it's a good time to do this.

—Exactly.

—Let's nag her with this tomorrow— Catra suggested. —She'll have to accept at some point.

They didn't stay up for much longer after that, and in the morning found themselves all tangled up. Except for Catra who was soundly resting at the feet of the bed, curled up in a ball like Melog.

As planned, that day the Best Friends Squad discussed their ideas for some huge cleanup of the whole castle, just like the staff was doing with Glimmer and Bow's room, but handling just a few rooms at the time. That way, the spare rooms would be enough to hold everyone displaced, and if Glimmer allowed Adora, Catra, and Bow to help, they would be done far quicker.

But they couldn't convince her. From breakfast until dinner, they kept insisting, yet she refused to have them repair the palace when they are already busy with the towns destroyed by the war.

Her decision was final.

Until the next day, that is.

The Best Friends Squad walked down the corridors, still trying to convince the Queen of their idea, aiming for Glimmer and Bow's room. They needed to get a few notes they had left on the desk the previous day, so Glimmer confidently walked in, without paying much attention.

—Um, Glim— Bow called.

—What?— she asked, turning around. Yet she didn't need an answer. —What the- No way!

The Queen was standing on a piece of ceiling. It had happened again.

—Calm down— Bow began, already seeing the rage in Glimmer's eyes.

—Is the whole palace falling apart!?— she yelled. However, her expression suddenly changed, and with a chilling tone, she said —You know what? I think I'll take your offer. You guys can help.

—Yeah, we better…— Catra muttered.

—Because not even your room is fixed yet! And now this one too!?— she yelled once again.

—Well, we'll just have to… sleep in a pri- spare room too— Bow said, trying to joke like the last time.

—I'm not in the mood, Bow!

—Sorry— he shyly apologized. —But it's alright, babe— he insisted. —We'll handle this. Why don't you take a break today?

—You know what? I think I will— she replied, exasperated. —I'll go ask Auntie to use the Steam Grotto…

—She needs it— Adora whispered.

—I heard you!

End Notes

Yes. A piece of my ceiling fell down.
(Edit as I wrote the wrong note here, oops) Also, if they had a pet, I would have written it doing here what my cat did irl.

Now, I hope you had fun and, in case you wanna read the other versions of this, if you like the other fandoms, here are the links:

Honkai Impact 3rd: Duranrita version
Genshin Impact: Jeanlisa version
She-Ra (2018): Catradora version, Castaweaver version

Thank you all for reading!!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!